Band Night

The mission



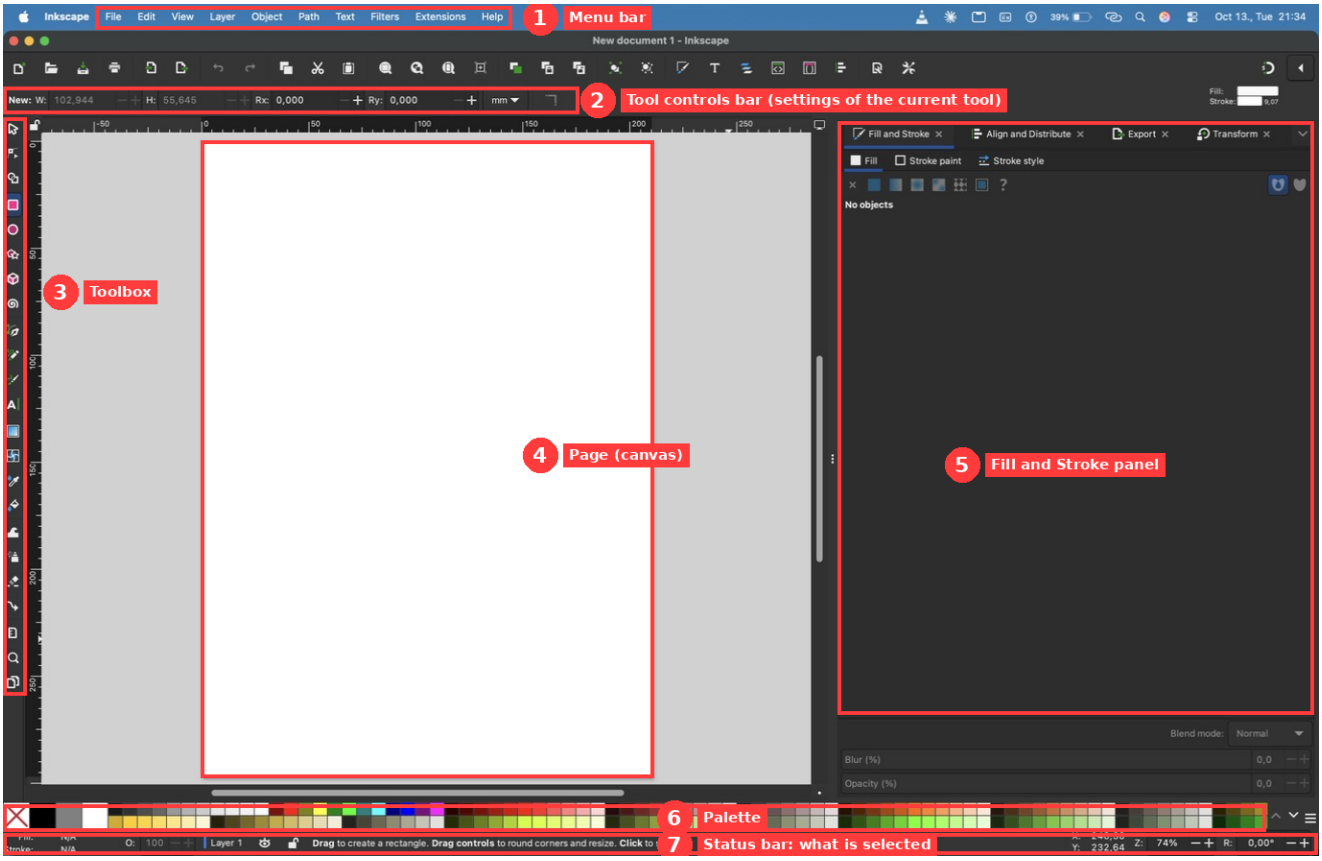
The school bands are playing on Friday night in the gym, and nobody has made a poster yet. You have one lesson. Text is the star again – but with new tricks: a different colour for every letter, words riding a sound wave, a line-up with a bigger heading, a speech bubble full of text and a letter you reshape yourself.

No keyboard shortcuts – every command is in a menu or on a toolbar. Hand in an SVG and a PNG. Colours, fonts and sizes are up to you; what counts is that every element is made the way the table says.

Element	How it is made	What you practise
Background and record	Rectangle tool, Ellipse tool, palette	warm-up: basic shapes, fill
Neon title BAND NIGHT	Text tool: click and type; drag over ONE letter, click a colour – letter by letter	styling part of a text
Sound wave	Pen tool zigzag line; text → Text ▸ Put on Path	text on a path you draw
Line-up	Text tool: drag a box, Enter after each line, centre; first line bigger and yellow	text box, paragraphs, alignment
Speech bubble	ellipse + triangle → Path ▸ Union; text → Text ▸ Flow into Frame	text in a shape
Spiky ROCK!	text → Path ▸ Object to Path → Node tool: pull a corner	text as a shape, Node tool

Before you start

This is Inkscape. You will use the numbered parts: menu bar, tool controls bar, toolbox, page, Fill and Stroke panel, palette, status bar.



File ▸ New a new document

File ▸ Save As... surname_bandnight.svg – then File ▸ Save every few minutes

View ▸ Zoom ▸ Zoom Page shows the whole page

Three things to remember about text:

CLICK = one line; DRAG = a text box. Click INTO a text to edit it

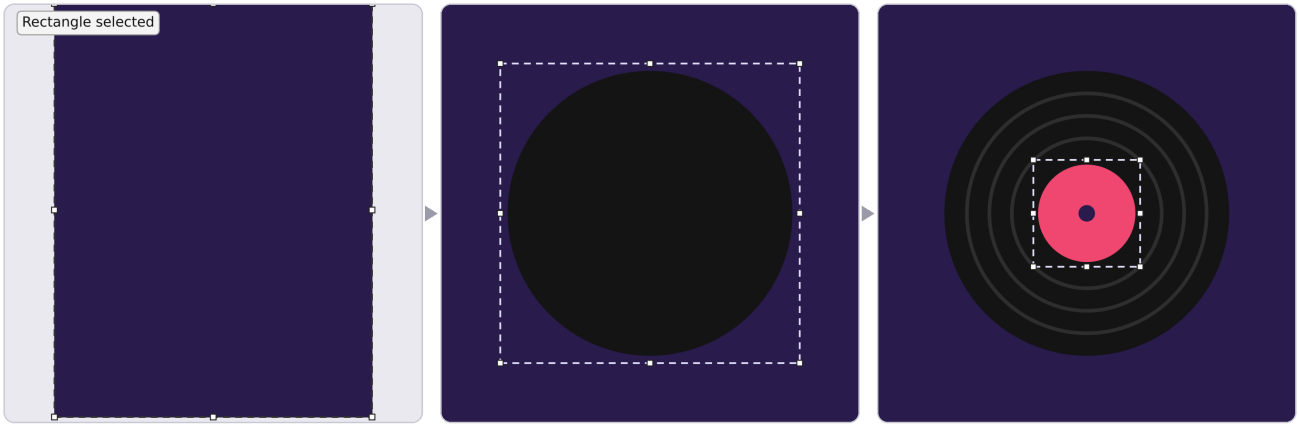
+ drag over some letters with the Text tool: colour and size change ONLY those letters

+ **Shift** Put on Path, Flow into Frame, Union: exactly 2 objects selected – read the status bar

New tool today: the **Pen tool** (the pen nib with a curve, under the spiral). Click, click, click – a straight line between each click – and double-click to finish. No keyboard shortcuts in this worksheet.

Step 1 – Background and record (warm-up)

Quick, with shapes you know.



1 → Rectangle over the whole page. Click dark purple.

2 → Big black circle on the right = the record.

3 → + Red circle in the middle (label), a tiny purple one = the hole.

Leave the top free for the title, the middle-left for the speech bubble and the bottom for the line-up and ROCK!

Step 2 – Neon title

One text, many colours: with the Text tool you can select single letters and change only those.



1 → Click, type BAND NIGHT. Bold font, size 72, click white.

2 Text tool: DRAG over the B – only that letter is selected.

3 → Click pink: only the B changes. Now drag over the A …

4 … a new colour for every letter. Neon title!

Selected letters get a blue highlight. If the whole title changes colour, you used the Selector – switch to the Text tool and drag over the letter.

Step 3 – Text on a sound wave

Draw your own path with the Pen tool, then put the text on it.



1 Pen tool: click, click, click from left to right. DOUBLE-click to finish.

2 **Object ▸ Fill and Stroke…** Stroke paint ▸ light blue, Stroke style ▸ width 2.

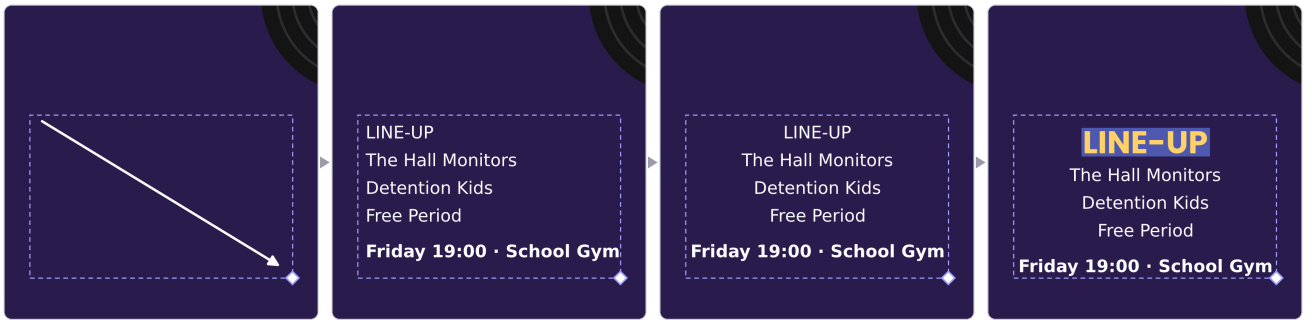
3 Click below, type LIVE MUSIC * FOOD * DANCING … Size 20.

4 + **Shift** → **Text ▸ Put on Path** Select the line AND the text: the words ride the sound wave.

Keep the zigzag gentle – at sharp corners the letters squeeze together. The text starts where you clicked first, so draw from left to right.

Step 4 – The line-up

A text box with several lines. Different sizes in one box: select a line, change its size.



1 DRAG a box at the bottom left for the line-up.

2 Type the lines, Enter after each. Size 16, white.

3 Centre button: every line is centred in the box.

4 → Drag over LINE-UP only: size 30, Bold, yellow.

Red frame? The text does not fit – drag the ◇ handle to make the box bigger.

Step 5 – Speech bubble

Union builds the bubble, Flow into Frame fills it with text.



1 + → White ellipse + a triangle tail pointing at the record.

2 + Shift → Path ▸ Union — Select both ▸ Union: ONE speech bubble.

3 — Click below, type: Bring your friends – entry is FREE!



4 + Shift → Text ▸ Flow into Frame — Bubble AND text selected: the text pours into the bubble.

5 + — Centre, dark colour. Make FREE! bold.

The tail must overlap the ellipse, or Union leaves two separate pieces. The text flows into the whole bubble – shorten your text if it does not fit.

Step 6 – Spiky ROCK!

After Object to Path the letters are an ordinary shape – you can edit their nodes like the tree in the Haunted House.



1 → Click at the bottom right, type ROCK! Bold, size 60, yellow.

2 → Path ▸ Object to Path — Now the letters are a shape (status bar: Path).

3 — Node tool: drag the top-right corner of the K up: a spike!

4 — Pull 1–2 more corners if you like. Done!

Check the spelling first: after Object to Path the letters can no longer be edited as text.

Step 7 – Save and hand in

File ▸ Save the SVG file

File ▸ Export… choose Page, name it surname_bandnight.png, click Export

Hand in both files: `surname_bandnight.svg` and `surname_bandnight.png`. (Older Inkscape: File ▸ Export PNG Image…)

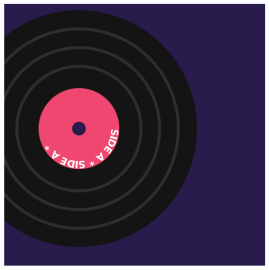
Bonus – if you have time left

Pick one or more.

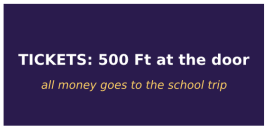
Task	Recipe
Glowing title	Select the title, Edit ▸ Duplicate, Object ▸ Lower, then Blur (%) in the Fill and Stroke panel – about 10
Record label text	A small circle on the label + text SIDE A * SIDE A * → Text ▸ Put on Path, small size
Ticket line	TICKETS: 500 Ft at the door – then a second line in a smaller, italic font in the same text
Music notes	small ellipse + thin rectangle + small triangle flag → Path ▸ Union; Edit ▸ Duplicate, new colour
Tilted title	Click the title twice, drag a corner arrow to tilt it a little



Glow: Edit ▸ Duplicate the title, Object ▸ Lower, Filters ▸ Blurs ▸ Blur… (or Blur % in Fill and Stroke)



Record label: a small circle + text ▸ Text ▸ Put on Path



Ticket line: one text, two sizes – drag over part of it, change only that part


Music notes: ellipse + thin rectangle + flag ▸ Path ▸ Union, Edit ▸ Duplicate

Bonus ideas: glow, record label, ticket line, music notes

Checklist before handing in

- ☐ Background covers the page; a record with a label
- ☐ BAND NIGHT in a bold font, every letter a different colour (one text object!)
- ☐ A zigzag line with LIVE MUSIC * FOOD * DANCING riding on it (Pen tool + Put on Path)
- ☐ Line-up in a text box: centred, LINE-UP bigger and yellow
- ☐ Speech bubble as ONE shape with the text inside it (Union + Flow into Frame)
- ☐ ROCK! with at least one pulled-out spike (Object to Path + Node tool)
- ☐ Both SVG and PNG saved, with your surname in the file name